

CodeAlpha Cybersecurity Internship

Task 2:

Phishing Awareness Training

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Penetration Tester

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Training Objectives

- ✓ Understand phishing attacks
- ✓ Identify phishing emails
- ✓ Recognize fake websites
- ✓ Understand social engineering
- ✓ Learn how to stay safe online



What is Phishing?

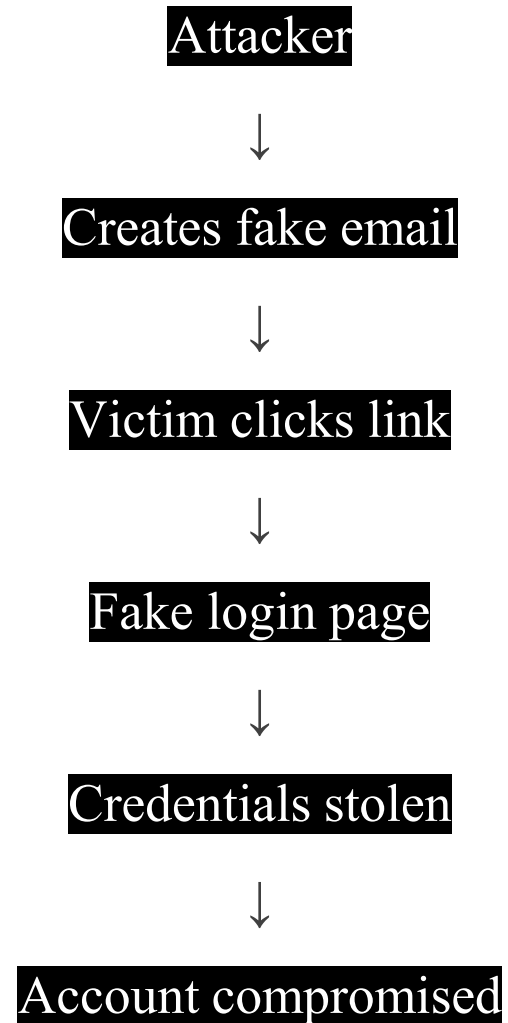
Phishing is a cyberattack where attackers impersonate trusted individuals or organizations to trick victims into revealing sensitive information, including Personally Identifiable Information (PII) and Sensitive Personally Identifiable Information (SPII).

Common Targets

- ▶ Usernames
- ▶ Passwords
- ▶ Credit card details
- ▶ Bank account information
- ▶ Personal data



How Phishing Works



Types of Phishing

Email Phishing

Fake emails sent to many users.

Spear Phishing

Targets one specific person.

Whaling

Targets executives.

Smishing

SMS phishing.

Vishing

Phone call phishing.

Clone Phishing

Copies legitimate emails.

Very professional.



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Anatomy of a Phishing Email

From: CodeAlpha Support

support@codealpha-security.com

Subject: URGENT: Verify Your Student Portal

Dear Student,

As part of our cybersecurity internship verification process, all interns are required to verify their student portal before their internship account is activated.

Failure to complete verification within 24 hours may result in:

- Internship suspension
- Loss of access to project submissions
- Removal from the internship portal

Click the button below to verify your account.

[**VERIFY PORTAL**]

<https://codealpha-verify-login.com>

Thank you.

CodeAlpha Student Support Team

Warning Signs

✗ Fake sender

✗ Urgent subject

✗ Generic greeting

✗ Immediate action

✗ Fake website URL



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Training Example: This email is fictional and created for awareness only.

Fake CodeAlpha Login Page (Phishing Website)

Fake Browser

 codealpha-verify.net/login

CODEALPHA Student Verification Portal

Verify your internship account to continue.

Email Address

Password

[Verify Account]

Red Flags

- ✗ Suspicious domain name
- ✗ Requests password immediately
- ✗ Uses urgency to pressure users
- ✗ Generic login page
- ✗ Not an official CodeAlpha website

 **Never enter your credentials until you have verified the website URL.**



Spot the Difference: Fake vs. Legitimate Website

✗ Phishing Website

- **Domain Name:**
codealpha-verify.net
- **HTTPS**
May use HTTPS to appear trustworthy
- **Website Design**
Similar or copied layout
- **Login Request**
Unexpected request to verify your account
- **Contact Information**
Missing, fake, or limited
- **Grammar & Spelling**
Errors or unusual wording

✓ Legitimate Website

- **Domain Name:**
codealpha.tech
- **HTTPS**
May use HTTPS with official company domain
- **Website Design**
Official branding and consistent design
- **Login Request**
Normal login only when you intentionally visit the website
- **Contact Information**
Official company contact details
- **Grammar & Spelling**
Clear and professional language



Key Takeaway: Always verify the DOMAIN NAME before entering your username or password. Attackers can copy a website's appearance, but they cannot use the company's official domain.



Social Engineering Techniques Used by Attackers



Impersonation

Pretending to be a trusted company or person.



Urgency

"Verify within 24 hours!"
Pressures victims to act fast.



Baiting

Offers fake rewards, gifts, internship with monthly, payment or job opportunities.



Fear

Threatens account suspension or data loss.



Trust

Uses familiar brands like CodeAlpha, banks, Google.



Authority

Pretends to be IT support, HR, or company management.



Key Takeaway Attackers often exploit human emotions rather than technical vulnerabilities. Stay calm, verify requests, and never rush to click suspicious links.

Best Practices to Prevent Phishing Attacks

 Verify the Sender Confirm the sender's email address.	 Check Links Hover over links before clicking and verify the destination.
 Enable MFA Add an extra security layer to your accounts.	 Keep Software Updated Install updates to fix known security vulnerabilities.
 Never Share Passwords Legitimate organizations won't ask via email.	 Report Suspicious Emails Report phishing emails to your IT team or email provider.

 **Think Before You Click**
Always verify emails, links, and websites before entering your credentials.

? Interactive Quiz: Spot the Phishing Signs

1. Which of the following is a common sign of a phishing email?

- A. Email from your manager about today's meeting
- B. Urgent request to verify your account immediately
- C. Newsletter you subscribed to
- D. Email from a trusted contact

2. Before clicking a link, you should:

- A. Click immediately if it looks familiar
- B. Hover over the link to inspect the destination
- C. Ignore the sender's address
- D. Disable your antivirus

3. What is the safest action if you suspect an email is phishing?

- A. Reply asking if it's real
- B. Enter your password to check
- C. Report the email and delete it
- D. Forward it to everyone



Pause the video and choose your answers before moving on.



Quiz Answers & Key Takeaways

Question 1: B

Urgent requests to verify your account are a common phishing tactic.

Question 2: B

Always hover over links to verify the destination before clicking.

Question 3: C

Report suspicious emails and delete them. Never interact with phishing messages.



Remember:



Think Before You Click



Verify the Sender



Check Website URLs



Enable MFA



Report Suspicious Emails



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Thank You for Watching!

Stay Alert. Stay Informed. Stay Secure.

Have a question or cybersecurity tip to share?

Leave it in the comments below.

Let's learn and grow together!

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